

Instructor: Date:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Do you know a lot about Sally's life?



Learning Outcome

Accurately use information about people's jobs and places of work in communicative situations.

Ask your partner:

- How much do you know about the person you admire the most?
- Do you like reading about the lives of others? Why or why not?

Can Do Statements

- I can write about jobs, work, and personal interests.
- I can talk about people's past experiences.
- I can write a short biography.





Let's Explore!

Listen to a **subscriber*** read Sally's biography.

* A person who pays money to get a publication or service regularly.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

About the author

Sally Davis is a recent addition to our team at Cambridge Life. Sally is a young woman with a natural talent for writing. She was born in Cambridge in 1990 and attended the local high school. From an early age, she was inquisitive, outgoing and enthusiastic about facing life's challenges head on. She excelled in the Creative Arts, was a member of the debate team and sat on the student council.

At college, she studied communications and started a blog that described her travels, her interest in food and learning about other cultures. This online blog provided the opportunity to express her ideas and views about the world. She also enjoyed receiving feedback and ideas from her followers. This sparked a career move into the magazine industry as a freelancer.

She plans to hone her writing skills and provide our readers with a fresh, new way of seeing the world. A yoga enthusiast, Sally enjoys spending time with friends and her cat Meeneee, and exploring this beautiful city. If you would like to contact Sally, please email her your thoughts and ideas at SallyD@CambridgeLife.com.





Let's Practice!

Let's talk about Sally's past experiences.

Instructions: Choose the words from the options to correctly complete the sentences.

Word Bank

sparked / attended / has excelled / was /
was / has provided / has / has lived / sat

1. She _____ born in Cambridge in 1990, _____ the local high school and _____ here all her life.
2. This online blog _____ the opportunity for her to express her ideas and views about the world.
3. This _____ a career move into the magazine industry as a freelancer.
4. She _____ in the Creative Arts, _____ a member of the debate team and _____ on the student council.



Let's Practice!

Tell us about Sally's work and personal interests.

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentences.

1. yoga / enthusiast, / Sally / spending / with / enjoys / time / A / friends / .

2. a / industry / career / freelancer / move / into / This / as / magazine / the / . /
sparked / a

3. her / also / feedback / receiving / enjoyed / and / from / . / ideas / She / followers

4. her / writing / . / plans / She / hone / to / skills

5. Sally / Davis / is / recent / Cambridge / . / team / a / Life / our / at / to / addition



Extension Activity

Who do or did you admire? Who do you want to know more about?

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Research a person you admire online.
- Write a 100-word biography about the person.
- Include dates, their interests, their background and what makes them special or interesting.
- Read the biography aloud to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I research a person online.

☐ ☐

I write an biography about a person I admire.

☐ ☐

I read my biography aloud to a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **natural talent** (expression): a person that is good at something without training
e.g. Sally is a young woman with a natural talent for writing.
- **inquisitive** (adjective): tending to ask questions
e.g. From an early age, she was very inquisitive.
- **to face challenges head on** (expression): to deal with difficult situations directly
e.g. Sally likes to face challenges head on.
- **student council** (noun): a small group of students who represent the interests of the students
e.g. She sat on the student council.
- **to spark** (verb): to make, to start
e.g. This sparked a career move into the magazine industry.
- **enthusiast** (noun): a person who is very interested in something
e.g. She is also a yoga enthusiast.
- **to hone** (verb): to perfect something, to improve a skill
e.g. She honed her skills while writing her blog.
- **to excel** (verb): to perform at a very high level
e.g. She excelled in writing.





Learning Points

Writing a Biography

A biography is simply the story of a life.

To write a biography you should:

- Do some research. Find out some facts. When was the person born? Are they still alive?
- Where did they grow up?
- What makes this person interesting or unique?
- What adjectives could you use to talk about this person?
- How did the person deal with problems?
- Write your biography in chronological order.

Simple Past vs Present Perfect

You use the **Present Perfect** when the time of an action is not important or not specified.

You use the **Simple Past** when details about the time or place of an action are given or requested.

Compare the differences below:

Present Perfect tense	Simple past tense
<i>I have lived in Toronto.</i>	<i>I lived in Toronto in 2010.</i>
<i>They have eaten Chinese food.</i>	<i>I ate Chinese food last night.</i>
<i>Have you seen that new movie?</i>	<i>Did you see that new movie?</i>

